

English IT 2

Conditionals: condition + result.

To talk about events which might be possible, if we are talking about specific events, or general ideas, or wishes, dreams or desires.

- Conditional Zero
- Conditional 1
- Conditional 2
- Conditional 3

Conditional Zero: general ideas, facts, rules

Is not related to any specific time. General events, things which happen regularly. It could be the past, the present or the future. It's not important.

"If I want a hot meal, I cook pasta."

General hot meals.

- If clause = simple present
- Result clause = simple present

Conditional 1: Talk about specific events.

"If I want a hot meal, I will cook pasta."

Specific hot meal, probably the one I will have tonight.

- If clause = simple present
- Result clause = simple future

"If I win the lottery, I will buy an island."

Talking about tonight's lottery competition, not lottery competitions in general.

- If clause = simple present tense
- Result clause = simple future tense

Conditional 2: for wishes, dreams, and desires.

General events, not specific ones.

"If I won the lottery, I would buy an island."

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- If clause = simple past tense
- Result clause = would/could/might + base verb

Conditional 3: things in the past that did not happen.

"If I had won the lottery, I would have bought an island."

you did not win the lottery, so you did not buy an island.

The rules for Conditional 3 are:

- If clause = past perfect
- Result clause = would/could/might + present perfect

Second Conditional Hypothesis and Speculation

IF + PAST SIMPLE,WOULD/COULD/MIGHT + INFINITIVE.

IF/CONDITION clause and the MAIN/RESULT clause.

"If we delayed the library integration, we could focus on fixing bugs reported by customers."

We are offering a suggestion, thinking of alternative courses of action.

"If you gave it more consideration, you might change your mind. I think we should delay."

We are speculating.

We don't have to use IF in the conditional clause. Here are some of the typical alternatives: UNLESS, SUPPOSING, PROVIDED THAT, OTHERWISE.

"Supposing we integrated with the new library now, would that be a mistake?"

"Provided that we deal with the delays in the interim, we might be okay."

Provided works the same as if, also suggests a stronger condition, like saying as long as we deal with the delays, then it's okay.

Conditionals / Only If Inversion

"If you help me, we will be able to run the backup sooner."

Or

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"If you helped me, we would be able to run the backup sooner."

Or perhaps after the fact, when we had to finish without any help, we could say:

"If you had helped me, we could have run the backup sooner."

To make things more formal, or add emphasis to the condition we are expressing, add **ONLY**, to form an inverted conditional sentence.

"Only if you provide the team with additional support will we be able to provide comprehensive service to our customers."

"Only if you managed to meet the deadline would we agree to renew the contract."

"Only if we updated the software would we be able to continue."

Prepositions

Make connections, or to indicate a relationship between nouns or other parts of our sentences.

IN, ON & AT. Prepositions of place.

AT are also used as **prepositions of time**, just like when we say **IN** summer, **ON** Wednesday, **AT** tomorrow's meeting.

through mean by way of; to say how the connection is made.

"My desktop and android device are connected through the same router."

Dependent prepositions. always go after certain verbs, nouns, or adjectives.

When we pay attention to a specific sound or a person speaking, we listen to it or them. We have to use **to** after listen. They seem incapable of reacting promptly.

"You need **to** listen to all the instructions carefully."

Due To

mean because of something.

In some situations, we may need to make it clear that something happened for **more than one reason**, we can use **adverbs to modify** our sentences.

"The system data loss was partly due to employees not following backup policies correctly."

Partly due to show that this is not the only reason for the system data loss. One variation on this is **due in part**.

"it was due in part to employees not following backup policies correctly."

Show that this is the most important reason, then we can say it is **largely due to**.

"The system data loss was largely due to employees not following backup policies correctly."

To make it even more formal, use **due to the fact that**.

"Due to the fact that employees have not followed backup policies correctly, system data loss has occurred."

Phrasal Verbs

The second word, the particle or preposition, usually gives us more information about the meaning.

Listen In: It prevents someone from listening in on the voice call.

To listen in on something is used to mean that we listen to a conversation when we are not supposed to, and when the people involved in the conversation do not know we are listening.

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Gerunds

Verb form which functions as a noun and has the suffix -ing. We use them after certain verbs, after prepositions, and as the subject of a sentence.

ENJOY - FANCY - DISCUSS - DISLIKE - FINISH - MIND - SUGGEST - RECOMMEND - KEEP - AVOID

"Would you **mind thinking** about the authentication system outage?"

"We have to **avoid affecting** multiple people in the company."

After prepositions.

When a **verb follows a preposition**, the verb has to be a gerund, taking the -ing form.

"I only noticed the problem after checking the account verification link."

gerund is checking, with -ing, because it follows our preposition **after**.

"We were able to succeed by focusing more on customer needs."

gerund is focusing, with -ing, because it follows our preposition **by**.

At **subjects**.

"Focusing more on customer needs has helped us to be more successful."

The verb focus works as the subject of the sentence, so it has to be a gerund, focusing, with -ing.

Gerunds as Objects

An adverbial prepositional phrase. When a gerund is used as the object of a preposition and it describes one action that modifies another action. This construction usually answers a question like why, how, or where? etc.

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"I'm using a library that seems to have a race condition, so the project has been temporarily stopped by the system freezing up."

In this sentence, have preposition **by** and its object freezing in the **gerund -ing form**. This adverbial phrase tells us what has happened, and answers the question: why has the project stopped?

Transitive Verbs

When a verb takes a direct object, and the action of this verb is done to someone or something.

FINISH. transitive verb because the task is the direct object of that verb. We finish something, we finish the task.

"Using a dynamically typed language means you might be able to finish the task faster."

LET. transitive verb because the compiler is the direct object of the verb. We let someone do something, we let the compiler help ensure that the interfaces do not break.

"Many people share the opinion that we should let the compiler help ensure that the interfaces do not break."

Fixed Expressions Omitting the Subject

IF

We don't need to say if it is necessary. The subject and be are omitted, just the fixed expression, if necessary.

"Please go ahead and report the issue to us, if necessary."

IF SO and IF NOT.

if so works as saying if you are, if that is the case or if that is true. The phrase is if so, not if yes.

"Are you following backup policies? If so, data loss prevention should be easier."

"Are you using the incident report form provided? If not, please do so in future."

Whether or Not

To say that it **doesn't really matter which of two possibilities** is true or correct, or that it's not important if something exists or not.

"Whether or not you agree is not relevant at this point. We need to admit the mistake and correct it."

"It really makes no difference whether or not you like the idea. These are the instructions we have been given, and we have to proceed."

Have no choice. They have an obligation to follow the orders they have been given, whether they like them or not.

"I don't know **whether** to report this customer's comments, or just see how it goes next time we have to speak."

It is like saying, I don't know if I should do this, or if I should do something else.

Word Formation

How a word is formed when it has to change from one word type to another.

If we begin with the verb FORM, we can then change from the verb to the noun by using what we call a suffix. A very common suffix which we use to form nouns is -tion, in this case to form a noun which is the result of a verb. Therefore, form becomes formation.

What's the real difference between acceptance tests and functional tests?

Noun acceptance and the adjective functional. First of all, let's look at acceptance.

Start with the verb ACCEPT, then change it to a noun with the suffix -ance to make ACCEPTANCE.

We can start with the verb FUNCTION (which is also a noun) and then add the suffix -al to make FUNCTIONAL, the adjective.

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Another useful tool we can use is a prefix. A prefix is added to the start of a word to change its form. We often use them to change between positive and negative forms.

Let's continue with the same words, accept and function.

If we accept something, we can say it is acceptable. But, if we choose not to accept something, it could be because it is unacceptable. We add the prefix -un to make a negative adjective.

If something functions, we can say it is functional. But if it doesn't work, it could be because of a malfunction. We are using the prefix -mal to make a negative noun. If something works in many ways, we can say it is multifunctional. We are using the prefix -multi as well as the suffix -al to make a positive adjective.

There are many prefixes and suffixes in English. They are multipurpose.

Idioms

Informal expressions which are not meant literally, and they represent a figurative meaning attached to a phrase.

There's nothing to it. Means that it was easy

"I have to say, the customer support agent who helped me was great. She solved the problem in no time, explaining how to update our company settings, which finally meant the meeting went ahead. There was nothing to it."

Do more harm than good. Making the situation worse

"To be honest, I wasn't that convinced that he actually knew what he was doing. I just thought that allowing a remote session might end up doing more harm than good. I prefer to find my own solution."

Counterproductive. Meaning something that works against productivity, making the situation more difficult or time-consuming, perhaps losing money in the process: doing more harm than good.